Growing Together

Montessori curriculum planning and record keeping | Ages 3-6 | Printable working packet

Use this packet alongside Montessori_Planning_and_Records.html, or print blank copies for a paper-based workflow. The library contains 126 planning outlines and 766 photo-aligned tracking items. They support trained staff; they are not a complete Montessori training album or an endorsed certification course.

The working cycle

1. Observe: notice interests, movement, language and the support actually needed.

2. Plan: choose a few purposeful invitations linked to evidence. Keep familiar work available.

3. Present: invite, demonstrate clearly, allow a choice, and show restoration.

4. Step back: protect concentration and allow repetition; intervene for safety and meaningful support.

5. Record: write dated facts and a possible next opportunity. Revisit across time and contexts.

Six connected areas

Practical life: Independence, coordinated movement, care of self and others.

Sensorial: Careful comparison, sensory language, order and discrimination.

Language: Conversation, sound awareness, writing, reading and meaning.

Mathematics: Quantity, symbols, place value, operations and mathematical language.

Cultural studies: Geography, living things, community, scientific inquiry and respect.

Art, music & movement: Creative choices, rhythm, expression, movement and collaboration.

Privacy and storage

The browser tool saves locally on the device, without accounts or automatic cloud backup. Export a full JSON backup regularly. Keep names and notes private. This system does not replace attendance, incident, medication, safeguarding or formal special-education records.

Print to A4 or US Letter using “Fit to printable area.” Blank tracker dates are not age expectations or evidence of a learning gap.

Sequence without deadlines

A mixed-age room offers different levels of work at the same time.

Exploring

Belonging, practical routines, coordinated movement, sensory comparison, oral language and concrete quantities. Offer accessible meaningful work and watch for readiness.

Developing

Longer sequences, finer comparisons, sound-symbol relationships, composing words, quantity-symbol connections and sustained inquiry. Keep earlier work available for repetition.

Extending

Reading for meaning, purposeful writing, concrete decimal operations, research, collaboration and creative projects. Greater complexity follows observable understanding, not a birthday.

Observation labels

Interest observed: A child noticed or chose related work; this does not establish performance.

Presented: A lesson was demonstrated; further presentations may be useful.

Practicing: A child is working with the material. Record errors and the support used.

Independent in observation: The child worked without the recorded adult support in this event. Keep observing across days and contexts.

Revisit / offer support: Another invitation, a different material or additional support may help. Avoid labels about the child.

Weekly review questions

What did the child return to? What support helped? Which current plan is no longer useful? Where do we lack observations? Which materials need repair or adaptation? What family perspective would help?

The separate three-year record book uses P for Presented, A for Assistance required, and I for Independent work in a dated observation. Year boundaries are set for each child, not fixed age bands.

Do not turn coverage into a quota. “Not recorded” is a statement about the record, not the child’s ability. Include home languages and accessible communication, movement and materials.

Child profile

Teaching information only. Use an identifier if a full name is unnecessary.

Child / identifier and date of birth

Enrollment date and guide / key teacher

Home languages and preferred communication

Strengths and sources of confidence

Current interests and repeated choices

Useful access and teaching supports

Family perspective and date of conversation

Keep medical, safeguarding and formal support documents in the program’s approved systems. Review the profile when interests or supports change.

Weekly invitations

Week of: _____ Guide / group: _____

Plan a small number of purposeful invitations. Maintain complete familiar work, a protected work cycle, outdoor access and room for the child’s own choices.

Day / date	Child or small group	Invitation / evidence for readiness	Prepare / adapt	Outcome / follow-up
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				

Child-chosen work and emerging interests to revisit

Environment preparation / repairs / family follow-up

Individual lesson plan

Child / small group: _____ Date / guide: _____

Area, lesson and direct aim

Observed readiness / relevant earlier work

Materials, preparation and access supports

Presentation sequence and restoration

Point of interest and feedback / control of error

Safety considerations and what to observe

Possible next invitation, depending on the outcome

Dated observation

Child / identifier: _____ Date / recorder: _____

Lesson / work and context of the invitation

What was actually seen or heard? Include a brief quote if useful.

Support actually given / how the child responded

Engagement and self-chosen repetition

Status in this observation - circle one

Interest observed | Presented | Practicing | Independent in observation | Revisit / offer support

Possible next invitation and when to revisit

Example: “Poured twice. On the second attempt, stopped before the cup filled and wiped one spill without a reminder.” Avoid “Mastered water work.” A declined invitation is not a failure.